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The scientific method is preferred over other ways of knowing because it is more

- reliable.
- Systematic.
- accurate.
- all of these.

The application of the scientific method to the study of educational problems is called

- inductive reasoning.
- deductive reasoning.
- educational research.
- grounded theory

Which of the following steps of the scientific method is exemplified by the researcher reviewing the literature and focusing on a specific problem that has yet to be resolved?

- Identify a topic.
- Describe the procedures to collect information.
- Analyze the collected information.
- State the results of the data analysis.

If a researcher was studying the use of various instructional approaches to the "multiple intelligences" of a class of students, he is likely to be conducting which type of research?

- Basic
- Applied
- Evaluation
- Action

If a researcher is studying the effect of using laptops in her classroom to ascertain their merit and worth, she is likely conducting which type of research?

- Basic
- Applied
- Evaluation
- Action

Which of the following studies most likely uses quantitative methods?

- Comparing test results across groups to understand the effects of a particular instructional approach.
- Understanding historical perspective for an educational topic.
- Understanding the shared beliefs and practices of teachers in a school.

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- Developing a theory grounded in the beliefs of the group being studied.

Which of the following is most aligned with a researcher using quantitative methods?
- Studying a large number of subjects as a detached, objective observer.
- Studying an interesting phenomenon in the context in which it naturally occurs.
- Communicating the results of the study in a loosely structured report that uses informal language.
- Using a research design that changes as narrative data is collected and analyzed.

Which of the following problems is most appropriate to a quantitative experimental approach?
- Studying the nature of student interactions in an inclusionary classroom.
- Studying the effect of using formative quizzes on student's knowledge of key concepts.
- Analyzing the use of a site-based decision making model as it is being implemented in a local high school.
- Understanding the experiences of a veteran teacher who has been moved into an administrative position in her school

Which of the following designs studies causal relationships?
- Descriptive
- Correlation
- Experimental
- Narrative

The results from which of the following designs examining the relationships between variables should not be interpreted as causal?
- Descriptive
- Correlation
- Experimental
- Ethnography

Which design would you use to assess the attitudes of parents, teachers, and students toward a new disciplinary policy?
- Descriptive
- Correlation

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- Causal-comparative
- Experimental

Which of the following designs is the best choice to investigate the effects of working part-time while a high school student?

- Descriptive
- Correlation
- Causal-comparative
- Non-experimental

Which of the following is an excellent source for a research topic?

- Theory
- Personal experience
- Replication of prior research
- Library searches
- All of these

What is the reason for consulting handbooks, yearbooks, encyclopedias, or reviews in the initial stages of identifying a research topic?

- They are readily available.
- They provide an overview of the issues related to a topic.
- They are primary sources.
- They avoid reporting statistical data so one can interpret the results more easily.

Which of the following is NOT a characteristic of a good research topic?

- It can be investigated through the collection and analysis of data.
- It focuses on a philosophical or ethical issue.
- It is theoretically or practically significant.
- It is ethical.

Which of the following is NOT a legitimate research problem as stated?

- What is the relationship between the number of books children read and their reading scores?
- Should competitive games be banned from elementary schools?
- What does it mean to be a special needs child "included" in Ms. Pierre's fourth grade class?

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- What are the major legal principles applied to educational cases decided by the U.S. Supreme Court?

Which of the following is the least appropriate research problem?
- Does studying Latin improve the standardized vocabulary test scores of seventh grade students?
- Does drilling fifth grade students with multiplication facts improve their standardized test scores?
- What is the relationship between students' math attitudes and math achievement?
- Should students have access to controversial novels in school?

Which of the following provides the BEST formal statement of a quantitative problem statement?
- Student achievement.
- Using portfolios
- Seventh grade students' writing skills.
- The use of portfolios affects students' writing skills.

A review of the literature can BEST be defined as a
- systematic identification and analysis of information related to the research problem.
- list of at least 20 journal articles.
- list of the five most important articles written on the topic.
- discussion of the appropriate methodology for conducting a study.

A review of the literature could enable a researcher to do which of the following?
- Ascertain what is already known about a topic.
- Identify methodological strategies for designing the study.
- Provide the insight necessary to develop a logical framework into which the topic fits.
- All of these.

The review of the literature investigating a little researched problem area is likely going to be
- very narrow given the preponderance of research on the topic.
- very narrow given the focus on a problem without much of a literature base.
- very broad given the unique nature of the problem and the lack of information on it.
- very broad because bigger is always better.

Why is a primary source often more valuable to a researcher than a secondary source?
- It gives general information about a particular topic.

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- It reviews relevant literature.
- It synthesizes the results from a number of studies.
- It provides detailed information about all aspects of a study.

Which of the following is NOT an advantage of using the Internet as a resource for information on a research topic?

- The breadth of coverage
- Access to full text articles
- Consistently high quality information
- Availability of current information
- Home pages that contain useful links to resources others have thought helpful

Which of the following differentiates the development of a quantitative problem from that of a qualitative problem?

- A qualitative problem is formulated much sooner in the research process.
- A qualitative problem is never narrowed or focused.
- A quantitative problem is formulated before data is collected and analyzed, but a qualitative problem emerges during the collection and analysis of data.

1. A quantitative problem is developed more systematically.

A literature review is characterized by all of the following EXCEPT

- Summarize and report each article.
- use important topics as the organizational structure of the review.
- analyze all articles for similarities and differences related to major topics.
- discuss implications relative to the research problem.

A hypothesis is defined as

- a tentative prediction of the results of the research.
- the operational definition of the results of the research.
- a qualitative research design.
- a quantitative study.

Which of the following is the BEST hypothesis?

- Taller students will have higher test scores than shorter students.
- Students taught in a co-operative group setting have higher achievement test scores than students taught in a traditional class.
- Students using laptops will do well.
- Some students will fail.

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The Virgilio Teacher Behavior Inventory (VTBI) is an observation instrument designed to measure in very concrete terms the abstract notion of "effective teaching behaviors." In research, the VTBI is known as

- A dependent variable
- An independent variable
- The construct of "effective teachers"
- An operational definition of effective teaching behaviors

A deductively derived hypothesis is helpful because it

- provides some indication of a theoretical framework for the study, because it is often derived from theory.
- facilitates stating the expected outcome of the study.
- can inform the researcher to focus on specific methods or designs.
- all of these.

Which of the following is a non-directional hypothesis?

- Teachers receiving holistic stress reduction training will be less stressed than teachers who do not receive such training.
- Teachers receiving holistic stress reduction training will have the same levels of stress when compared to teachers who do not receive such training.
- Teachers receiving holistic stress reduction training will have significantly lower levels of stress when compared to teachers who do not receive such training.
- Teachers receiving holistic stress reduction training will have significantly higher levels of stress when compared to teachers who do not receive such training.

Which of the following describes a null hypothesis?

- Teachers receiving holistic stress reduction training will be less stressed than teachers who do not receive such training.
- There will be no difference in the stress scores of teachers receiving holistic stress reduction training and those not receiving such training.
- Teachers receiving holistic stress reduction training will score significantly lower on a stress test than teachers who do not receive such training.
- Teachers receiving holistic stress reduction training will score significantly higher on a stress test than teachers who do not receive such training.

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The following hypothesis was tested: Teachers receiving holistic stress reduction training will demonstrate lower levels of stress than teachers who do not receive such training. The results of the study indicated teachers receiving the training had lower levels of stress. Which of the following BEST describes these results?

- The results support the hypothesis.
- The results do not support the hypothesis.
- The results prove the hypothesis.
- The results disprove the hypothesis.

Ms. LeBlanc wants to measure her students' attitudes toward math. Attitudes are an example of a(n)

- construct.
- operational definition.
- variable.
- independent variable.

Variables such as gender, ethnicity, or political affiliation are measured on which scale?

- Interval
- Ratio
- Categorical
- Quantitative

Independent variable is to dependent variable as

- Effect is to cause.
- Predictor is to criterion.
- Cause is to effect.
- Criterion is to predictor.

Which of the following represents the most general, broad concept?

- Test
- Assessment
- Measurement
- Instrument

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Which type of response format BEST describes the following item? Discuss the fundamental assumptions underlying positivistic and post-positivistic philosophies of science.

- Selection
- Criterion-referenced
- Norm-referenced
- Supply

Which of the following BEST describes an assessment that examines students' ability to conduct a chemistry experiment in the lab?

- Standardized test
- Aptitude test
- Interest inventory
- Performance assessment

A test measuring what students currently know is BEST described as which type of test?

- Achievement
- Aptitude
- Affective
- Projective

Bias is defined as

- the distortion of responses based on gender, ethnicity, race, or language.
- a lack of validity.
- a lack of reliability.
- a poor interpretation of a student's score.

Which of the following type of scale is likely measuring a student's deeply held beliefs about certain ideas?

- The Study of Values
- The Attitudes Toward School Scale
- The Strong Campbell Interest Inventory
- The Minnesota Multiphasic Personality Inventory

Which type of scale requires a student to respond to an item based on whether they strongly disagree, disagree, agree, or strongly agree?

- Likert

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- Semantic differential
- Rating
- Thurstone

The extent to which a test provides scores that are meaningful, appropriate, or useful is referred to as

- reliability.
- validity.
- accuracy.
- social desirability

A common complaint about policies that require students with special needs to take on-grade-level high stakes tests is focused on

- Construct validity
- Content validity
- Predictive validity
- Consequential validity

Which of the following is likely to reduce the validity of a test?

- Unclear test directions
- Ambiguous items
- Untaught items
- All of these

Test reliability refers to

- the extent to which the test measures what it is supposed to measure.
- consistency in the test results.
- generalizabilty of the research results.
- the types of writing errors that exist in the test.

Which of the following reliability estimates require only a single administration of a test?

- Stability
- Equivalence
- Internal consistency
- None of the above

Which of the following is the appropriate way in which to view the reliability of observational data?

- Test-retest

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- Parallel forms
- Internal consistency
- Inter-rater reliability

The primary purpose of descriptive research is to
- describe the way things are.
- predict the way things will be based on the way things are.
- identify relationships between variables.
- find cause and effect relationships

Descriptive research is important because it
- can be used to influence opinions.
- is useful for investigating a variety of educational problems.
- is easily and frequently used.
- all of these.

Qualitative research and descriptive research are similar in that both
- examine topics primarily from participants' perspectives.
- use observation and interviews.
- are guided by predetermined variables to study.
- have large samples.

Which of the following is a necessary component of descriptive research?
- Identifying a problem
- Reviewing the literature
- Collecting and analyzing data
- All of these

The major problem with non-respondents in descriptive research is that
- they tend to be alike in many ways.
- data can be analyzed only for an entire sample.
- they can have different opinions than respondents.
- they cannot be found under any circumstances.

An ambiguous item on a questionnaire is likely to affect
- reliability.
- response rate.

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- respondents understanding the question.
- all of the above.

The two most common categories of descriptive research are based on
- how data are collected and when data are collected.
- how data are collected and the size of the sample needed.
- when a group is surveyed and the size of that group.
- the size of the sample selected and the type of instrument used

A survey designed to collect data on a subset of the population is known as a
- sample survey.
- school survey.
- developmental survey.
- cross-sectional survey.

survey used to identify specific stages in which children might be operating is known as
- sample survey.
- school survey.
- developmental survey.
- cross-sectional survey.

Which of the following type of survey collects data from 7th, 8th, 9th, and 10th grade students at the same time?
- Sample
- Developmental
- Cross-sectional
- Longitudinal

Which type of survey collects data over a four-year period of time from the same group of students as they move from the 7th to the 10th grade?
- School
- Cross-sectional
- Longitudinal
- Sample

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Which type of longitudinal survey tracks the responses of a new sample of the original population of respondents for several years?

- Trend
- Cohort
- Panel
- Follow-up

Which of the following is more problematic in longitudinal studies than in cross-sectional studies?

- Validity of instruments
- Comparability of sample groups
- Shrinkage of sample
- Data analysis